

"Good people aren't given chances, they don't come forward." But some do, like chief selector Dilip Vengsarkar, his colleague Sanjay Jagdale, CAO Ratnakar Shetty, coaches Robin Singh and Venkatesh Prasad or T.A. Sekhar at Chennai's MRF Pace Foundation and constructive critics like Arun Lal, Saba Karim and Ravi Shastri.

Tomorrow is actually brighter than it seems. Of India's players today, Anil Kumble could make a fine coach and Sourav Ganguly an astute non-parochial selector. Rahul Dravid has the mind to turn the National Academy into the place it should be. There is no better roving ambassador for our cricket than Sachin Tendulkar, a proud Indian, steeped in modern game, universally loved and who loves cricket himself like a boy with a bat.

This is a hunt for Indian cricket's future leaders who deserve authority and responsibility in the next five years. Hearing their names, an insider commented wryly, "What you're actually doing is ruining their chances."

The crabby and the cynical may rule today. But the future is coming.

COACHING

ROGER BINNY/
PARAS MHAMBREY



ATUL KAMBLE/MID-DAY

GEN NEXT: Mhambrey is rated among the young coaches of the future



STILL WORKING: Coach Binny needs to come home

Asked if he was ready to dehydrate himself into nothingness playing a mongrel tournament called the Afro-Asia Cup, one Indian cricketer replied, "I'm not playing for Asia or on Mahela's team, I'm playing for Roger Binny's." Whenever local patriots jump to their feet and suggest Indian names for the post of Indian coach, their candidature rarely ventures beyond a handful, which, if you leave out the most credible Sandeep Patil who has had success overseas, are a famil-

iar crew: Krishnamachari Srikkanth, Mohinder Amarnath, often the former India coach Anshuman Gaekwad with a stopover to pay passing obeisance to Kapil Dev and Sunil Gavaskar.

Rarely does anyone mention the name of former India all-rounder Roger Binny. Maybe because in 1999 Binny, with his star on the ascent, was dispatched by Jagmohan Dalmiya to the Asian Cricket Council in Malaysia where he still works. Recently Binny, 51, made a brief though typically understated return to Indian action when he coached Asia in the recent Afro-Asian Cup. The Indians on his team were grinning through their sweat for many of them have worked with Binny during his most productive years as a coach in India with the under-19 team that won the junior world cup in Sri Lanka, the India under-17s to their World Cup and the India A team to the West Indies. He is a hardworking and knowledgeable man who is trusted and appreciated still by the players he has worked with. These are not common qualities in all those aspiring to be India's coaching stars. All it needs today, is for India to ask him to come home.

The caterwauling around *desi* vs *videshi* coach is impressively patriotic but when candidates are sought, everyone looks into the past, and not the future. Former England fast